

PROJECT SLIDESHOW

SOPHIE MODIGLIANI-MCGRANE

PROJECT

01

DARK ROOM TRASH

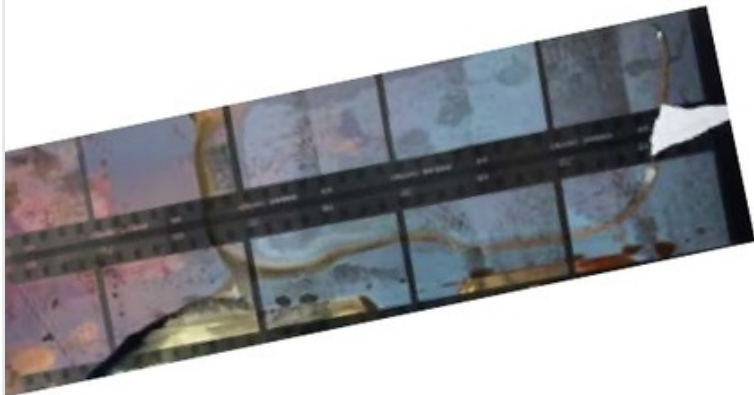
A STUDY IN DISCARD

This book is a curation of the contents of a darkroom trash can. Neither found photography nor intentional creation, the images exist somewhere in between. Many of these photographs never saw the light. Their potential and full chemical development were only realized through my exploration of the material as I collected and assembled them into a book, exposing them to light in the process. The book was exhibited at the MoMA PS1 Art Book Fair in 2025.

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PROJECT

02

TRINITY IN 50

DETAIL STUDIO

Trinity in 50 tells the story of Trinity College Dublin through fifty objects chosen by students, staff, and alumni that reflect the institutions storied past. I assisted Al Higgins in photographing the selected items, including the historic Blue Clock above the Front Gate, once synchronized to Dublin Mean Time, and the cobblestone path, partially paved over nearly 100 years ago, that leads students through the institution. Each image carries its own story and interpretation of Trinitys past, and the book reflects the many perspectives that have passed through the Front Gate...

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PROJECT

03

ERGONOMIC HAMMER ART

SCULPUTRE TA, OBERLIN

During my time as the sculpture TA where I oversaw the sculpture lab and woodshop, a beloved space filled with well-used tools and paint-splattered stools. I began a small project that eventually became known to the students as Ergonomic Hammer Art. Wanting to give these objects another life, I hand-whittled new grips from shop scraps, sanding and shaping each one to fit more comfortably in students' hands, then polished and reassembled the hammer heads to upgrade rather than replace them. I did the same with our stools, stripping back the old finish and giving them a cosmetic update...

Ergonomic Hammer Art

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PROJECT

04

RAMY BROOK

MARKETING INTERN

As a marketing intern at Ramy Brook, I worked closely with the art director to create visual assets across email, social media, and digital campaigns. I supported graphic design and photo editing needs, helping shape seasonal campaigns that stayed true to the brands color palette, typography, and overall aesthetic. My goal was always to make the layouts visually clear and engaging while enhancing the stories each campaign aimed to tell.

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PROJECT

05

MAD RIVER

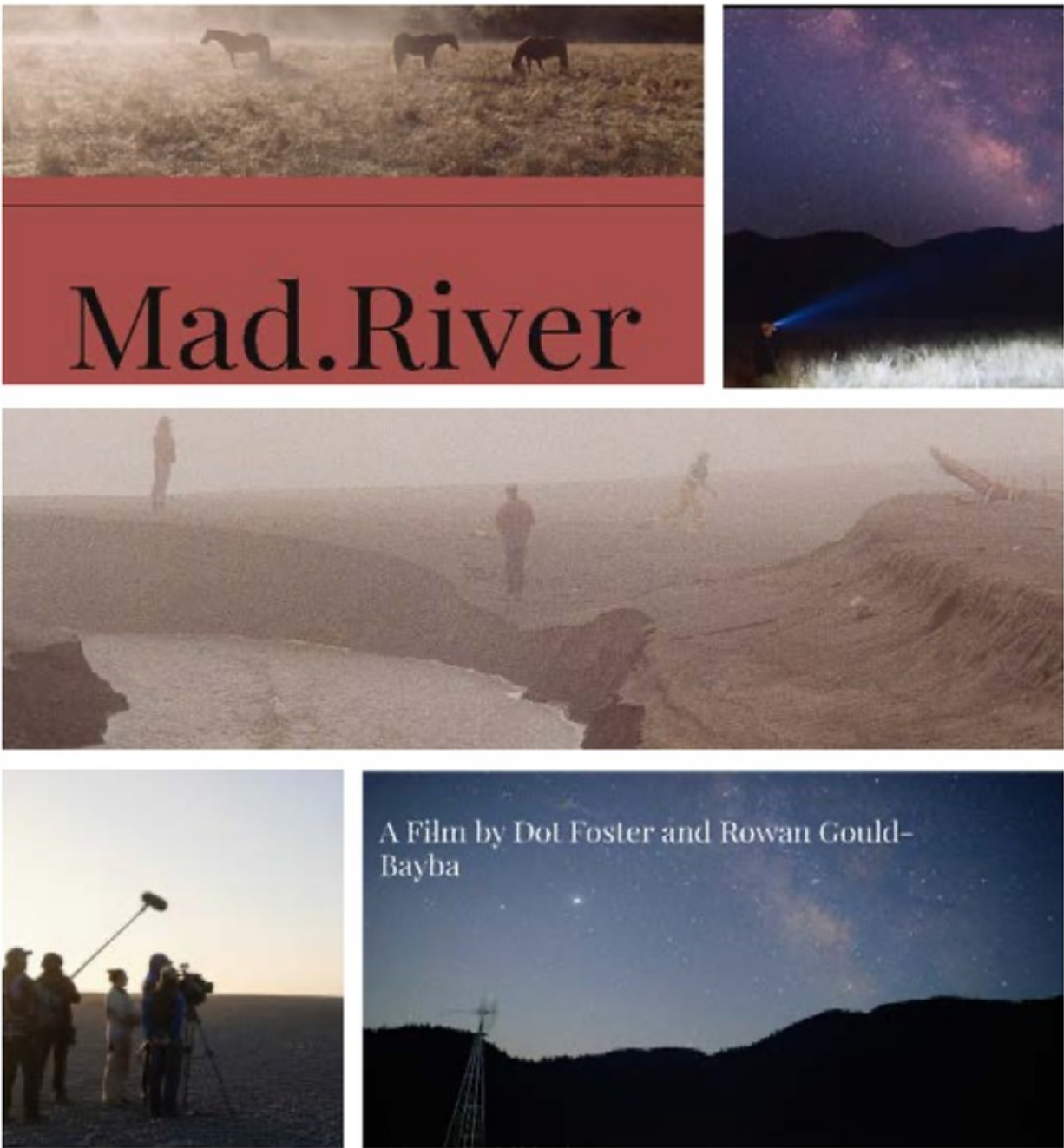
A FILM

Mad River was an incredible project to be part of. I was lucky to serve as the art director for my friend Rowan’s film, an ode to his familys land in Northern California. Inspired by the landscape and the films quietly powerful narrative, I developed a visual language and identity that guided the project from its earliest stages through fundraising and outreach, festival submissions, and its life in the public eye. I shaped a palette drawn from natural light and terrain and paired it with typography that echoed the films softness and grit, lending the work a grounded...

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PROJECT

06

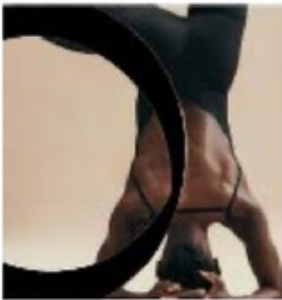
ONE PILATES

DETAIL STUDIO

Through my work with Detail Studio, I had the opportunity to help develop visual assets for ONE Pilates, a new studio focused on movement and flow. This project was especially meaningful to me because it marked my first sustained experience working with typography. What initially felt unfamiliar quickly became confidence-building and creatively expansive. I worked on imagery and graphics for social media, shaping a visual language drawn from the studios symbols and philosophy. By exploring type as form and integrating it seamlessly into images, I developed an...

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PROJECT

07

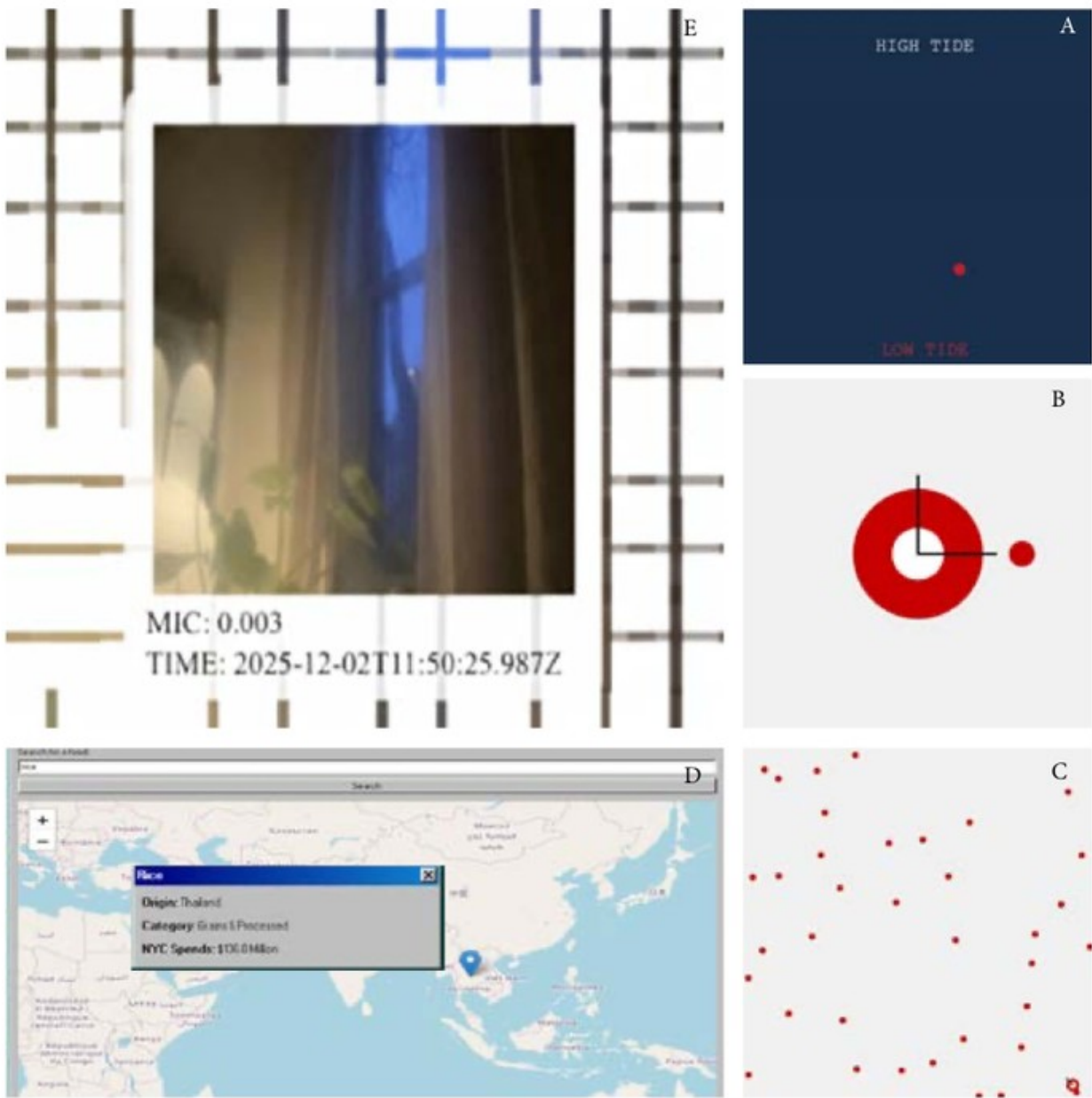
TECH A

IN CLASS PROJECT

This semester in Technology A was my first experience learning to code, and it opened up an entirely new way of thinking about systems, storytelling, design, and data. At its core, this class became, for me, about exploring the connective tissue of the world around us, the intangible systems and rhythms that quietly shape daily life made visible through data, interaction, and the technologies at our fingertips. My first project transformed the manual for a tide clock I had repaired into a website, balancing the tiny mechanical details of coding and clock systems with the larger celestial...

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PROJECT

08

SENIOR THESIS

INSTALATION

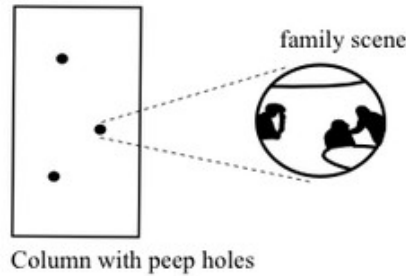
In my senior thesis showcase I explored how images construct intimacy, distance, voyeurism, and narrative in a world saturated with screens. Asked viewers to physically engage with the work. For the exhibition, I extended this inquiry by bringing my photographs into physical form. Images of my family during the COVID pandemic were printed and etched into wood, canvas, leather, glass, and other materials. (B) A custom lightbox system I designed was housed inside a column that echoed those in the gallery, (A) turning it into a miniature picture window that viewers could peer into (D). I also created a series of freestanding sculptures built from the spaces between figures in my photographs, (E) the cutouts of negative space, each around four feet tall and deliberately awkward to navigate.

Grounded in experimental photographic processes and expanded through my study of sculpture, the exhibition became both playful and intimate, asking viewers to physically interact with the work (C) while reflecting on the past four years and my continued interest in how images occupy space, time, and attention.

Senior Thesis
Instalation

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PROJECT

09

PAN AM RELAUNCH

The P an Am relaunch is grounde d in a return to what onc e define d P an Americ an W orld Airw a ys, positioning air tra v el not as transportation, but as an intentional and aspirational e xperienc e. F ounde d in 1927 and c entral to the dev elopment of international a viation, P an Am estab lishe d not only glob al routes, but the standards, infrastructure, and cultural perc eption of long distanc e tra v el. By the 1950s and 60s, it transf orme d flying into a premium e xperienc e, define d b y sp acious c abins, fine dining, and a sense of c ontro lle d glob al mo v...

PAN AM LOGO EVOLUTION



The Pan Am relaunch is grounded in a return to what once defined Pan American World Airways, positioning air travel not as transportation, but as an intentional and aspirational experience. Founded in 1927 and central to the development of international aviation, Pan Am established not only global routes, but the standards, infrastructure, and cultural perception of long distance travel. By the 1950s and 60s, it transformed flying into a premium experience, defined by spacious cabins, fine dining, and a sense of controlled global movement. The project begins with the recognition that this coherence was its greatest strength, and that its decline was driven by overexpansion following deregulation and the loss of that control. In response, the relaunch proposes a more disciplined model, one that is limited, high end, and carefully structured, positioned between commercial aviation and private travel. It operates on the belief that consistency, clarity, and restraint create lasting value.

The work develops through a process of research, contextual analysis, and strategic design, informed by both the history of the airline and a contemporary understanding of luxury and mobility. Particular attention is given to Pan Am's early identity system developed with Chermayeff & Geismar, where the blue globe, typography, aircraft livery, ticketing, and interiors formed one of the first fully integrated corporate design systems. This idea of total design becomes the foundation of the project. From this, the work expands into a complete system where identity, service, interface, and spatial experience are designed as one continuous framework.

The visual language evolves Pan Am's legacy through a deepened navy palette, referencing the original globe while refining it into a more contemporary register, paired with lighter blue accents that maintain its recognizability and sense of play. Typography draws from classical references such as Garamond, an old-style serif typeface originally influenced by Renaissance handwriting, grounding the system in clarity and elegance. Forms and symbols borrow directly from aviation language, runways, routes, and aircraft geometry, allowing the brand to integrate seamlessly into its context.

The project is proposed through a series of slideshows referencing the glossy magazines such as Life Magazine, and advertising layouts of the 1950s and early jet age, where pacing, spacing, and sequencing create a sense of calm, anticipation, and direction. This editorial approach mirrors the experience itself, balancing quiet intentionality with a sense of luxury and movement. The service model introduces membership based travel inspired by private aviation, paired with a seamless door to destination experience that removes fragmentation and restores continuity. Aircraft interiors are reimagined as calm, lounge like environments, drawing from mid century California modernism and references such as Axel Vervoordt, with controlled lighting, soft materials, and spatial openness, while acoustic considerations echo the precision of Yasuhisa Toyota. The result is an environment that feels less like transport and more like a private, continuous space.

The final output is a fully articulated brand and service proposal that spans customer experience, route strategy, digital interface, and physical space, all unified through a consistent design system. The project ultimately reflects an approach to design rooted in reduction and alignment, where each element supports a larger structure. Rather than expanding outward, the relaunch focuses inward, building a coherent system that allows the brand to operate with clarity and intention in a contemporary context, reasserting travel not as a transaction, but as a carefully designed experience.



THE NEW PAN AM

DIGITAL ECOLOGIES

P an Am In terf ac e: Digital E c o l ogies The P an Am In terf ac e e xtends the r elaunc h of P an Americ an W orl d Airw a y s in to a digital en vir onmen t, translating its c or e princip l es and d esign languag e in to an in teractiv e s y stem. De v el ope d within the frame w ork of Digital E c o l ogies, the pr oje ct c onsid ers ho w a brand operates ac r oss sc r e en-b ase d en vir onmen ts, no t as a static id en tity , but as a r esponsiv e, sc alab l e s y stem. The in terf ac e is gr ound e d in the customer perspe ctiv e, f ocusing on ho w the servic e is actuall y use d, e...



PROJECT

11

TOPOGRAPHY OF SLEEP

11:34:00 pm - 7 :02:00 am T opogr aph y of Sleep T opogr aph y of Sleep begins wit h t he most intangible subject I could t hink of , dr eams, and asks ho w somet hing inher ent ly ungr aspable can be r ecor ded, structur ed, and underst ood. The pr oject cr eat es a dataset on m yself , using t he body as a r ecor ding instrument o v er t he course of a single night. Rat her t han att empting t o captur e dr eams dir ect ly , it w orks t hr ough a pr o xy: mo v ement. What is measur ed is not t he dr eam it self , but t he t hr esholds ar ound it, moment s of tr ansition betw een...

11:34:00 pm - 7:02:00 am



Topography of Sleep

Topography of Sleep begins with the most intangible subject I could think of, dreams, and asks how something inherently ungraspable can be recorded, structured, and understood. The project creates a dataset on myself, using the body as a recording instrument over the course of a single night. Rather than attempting to capture dreams directly, it works through a proxy: movement. What is measured is not the dream itself, but the thresholds around it, moments of transition between unconscious and waking states.

The work unfolds as a continuous sequence. From this, a rule based visual system is developed, where each unit of time corresponds to a mark. Each dot is a drawn line, a moment mapped out, and each reiteration carries weight, accumulating into a field and image. The act of designing becomes one of defining rules, how information is broken down, categorized, and consistently represented.

This leads to a structured visual system where dots operate as the primary language. Each point represents a discrete moment, and together they accumulate into a field that maps the body's movement through time. The system oscillates between abstraction and legibility, functioning as both image and data. Visually, it draws from pointillism, halftone printing, and early computational plotting, as well as topographical maps and surveillance imagery, systems traditionally used to map external conditions, here redirected inward.

The final output is a series of compositions that read as both landscapes and datasets, a topography not of land, but of sleep. The project ultimately reflects an understanding of design as a method of structuring questions. By building a repeatable system, it shifts from trying to capture the intangible to defining the conditions under which it can be observed, allowing experience to be translated, organized, and continuously interpreted over time.